

Folk Dances of India

Topper Notes — 102 PYQ-Style Questions | Complete State-wise Coverage

North · South · East · West · Northeast · Central India

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① Ghoomar — Meaning in Rajasthani

Q1. Ghoomar means _____ in Rajasthani.

Answer: Twirling / Spinning (Ghoomna = to spin/twirl)

→ Complete Notes — Ghoomar

Detail	Information
Meaning	Twirling / Spinning
Originally performed by	Bhil tribe (to worship Goddess Saraswati)
Later adopted by	Rajput community
Performed during	Teej festival, Gangaur festival (mainly in Rajasthan)
Also performed in	Haryana (with slightly different costumes)
Famous reference	Deepika Padukone performed it in movie Padmaavat

NOTE

Gangaur festival is mainly celebrated in Rajasthan.

② Dandiya Raas — Gujarat Stick Dance

Q2. Which dance form from Gujarat is performed with sticks or batons during Navratri?

- A Dandiya Raas**
- ~~B Garba~~
- ~~C Kolattam~~
- ~~D Perini Shiva Tandavam~~

Answer: A — Dandiya Raas

→ Complete Notes — Dandiya Raas vs Garba

Feature	Garba	Dandiya Raas
Timing	Before Aarti	After Aarti
Props	No sticks; dance around central lamp (Garbhadeep)	Sticks/Batons
Symbolism	Women dance in circles around central lamp	Mock fight between Goddess Durga and Mahishasura
Meaning	Garbha = Garbhadeep (lamp)	Victory of good over evil
State	Gujarat	Gujarat

→ Kolattam

- ✓ Called: **Stick Dance**
- ✓ No specific single state — performed throughout **South India**
- ✓ States: **Andhra Pradesh, Tamil Nadu, Karnataka**
- ✓ Performed during: **Pongal festival** (mainly Tamil Nadu)
- ✓ Mainly performed by: **Women**
- ✓ Memory trick: 'This is Dandiya from South India'

→ Perini Shiva Tandavam

- ✓ Started by: **Kakatiya Dynasty** (Warangal)

- ✓ Also known as: **Dance of Warriors**
- ✓ Similar to: **Haka culture** of New Zealand (Samoa tribe — performed to scare enemies)
- ✓ State: **Telangana**
- ✓ Dedicated to: **Lord Shiva**
- ✓ Purpose: **To inspire soldiers before battle** (violent, energetic dance)
- ✓ Revived by: **Dr. Nataraja Ramakrishna** (in modern times)
- ✓ Originated from: **Kakatiya Dynasty** (NOT Chola Kings)

③ Folk Dance of Chhattisgarh

Q3. Which of the following is a dance form of Chhattisgarh?

- ☒ A **Bison Horn Maria**
- ☐ B ~~Gaddi Naati~~
- ☒ C **Baiga Pardhoni**
- ☐ D ~~Bugurumba~~

Answer: C — Baiga Pardhoni (primary CG answer). Note: Bison Horn Maria is also CG (Bastar).

→ **Bison Horn Maria**

- ✓ Performed by: **Maria / Dandami Maria tribe** (sub-group of **Gond tribe**)
- ✓ Region: **Bastar, Chhattisgarh** (also Jharkhand areas)
- ✓ Men wear: **Bison horn headgear**
- ✓ Women wear: **Ornaments made of brass or silver**
- ✓ Also associated with: **Ghotul** (tribal education/social institution in Bastar)
- ✓ Shifting cultivation in Bastar called: **Deepa**

→ **Gaddi Naati**

- ✓ State: **Himachal Pradesh**
- ✓ Region: **Bharmour, Chamba Valley**
- ✓ Performed by: **Gaddi tribe**
- ✓ Himachal Pradesh has 3 main regions: **Chamba Valley, Kullu, Sirmour**

→ **Baiga Pardhoni**

- ✓ Performed by: **Baiga tribe**
- ✓ States: **Madhya Pradesh and Chhattisgarh (both)**
- ✓ Occasion: **Wedding procession** (to welcome bride's family)
- ✓ Nature: **Very energetic dance**
- ✓ Memory trick: 'Baiga to Baraat' — performed during wedding procession
- ✓ Other Baiga dances: **Karma, Saila, Phagg**

→ **Bugurumba**

- ✓ Performed by: **Bodo tribe from Assam**
- ✓ Also called: **Butterfly Dance**
- ✓ Performed mainly by: **Women**
- ✓ Occasion: **New Year's Eve dance**

EXAM TIP

Current Affairs 2026: Modi visited Assam 10,000+ performers performed Bugurumba at Sarusajai Stadium (now renamed Arjun Bhogeshwar Barua Stadium), Guwahati Guinness World Record. Called Bugurumba Dhau. Symbolizes nature (butterflies, birds).

④ Traditional Dance of Kerala — Theyyam

Q4. Which of the following is a traditional dance of Kerala?

- ☒ A Theyyam
- ☐ B Dholchatom
- ☐ C Gidda
- ☐ D Bhangra

Answer: A — Theyyam

→ **Theyyam**

- ✓ Also known as: '**Of Gods**' (performers take form of god/sacred deity)
- ✓ Performance timing: **November to April** (evening to morning)
- ✓ Nature: **Very intense performance** with terrifying costumes and makeup
- ✓ Region: **North Malabar** (Kerala coast — districts of **Kannur and Kasargod**)
- ✓ Performing community: **Vannam and Malayan community**

✓ Festival: **Kaliyattam festival**

→ **Dholchalom (Dhol Chalom / Pung Chalom)**

✓ State: **Manipur**

✓ Drum used: **Pung** (type of drum)

✓ Nature: Starts slow gradually becomes very energetic

✓ Performed mainly by: **Men** (energetic warrior-type dance)

✓ Occasion: **Yaosang (Holi in Manipur)**

✓ Note: Holi is called **Yaosang** in Manipur

→ **Gidda & Bhangra**

✓ **Gidda**: State = **Punjab**; performed during Teej and Lohri; **women only**; circle or holding hands; songs = **Boliyan**

✓ **Bhangra**: State = **Punjab** (most famous folk dance); instrument = **Dhol**

⑤ Wedding Dance of Kerala — Uppana

Q5. Which of these dances is typically performed during weddings in Kerala?

A Uppana

B Hojagiri

C Gidda

D Dhamaat

Answer: A — Uppana

→ **Uppana**

✓ Performed by: **Mappila community** (Muslim community of Kerala, Malabar region)

✓ Occasion: **Marriage ceremonies**

✓ Historical connection: **Moplah/Mappila Rebellion 1921** (Malabar region — initially supported by Congress, then became Hindu-Muslim conflict; Muslim farmers revolted against Hindu landlords)

TWO TYPES OF UPPANA

1. **Uppana Chayal** No clapping
2. **Uppana Murukkam** Rhythmic continuous clapping

→ Hojagiri

- ✓ State: **Tripura**
- ✓ Performed by: **Bru Reang community**
- ✓ Festival: **Hojagiri festival** (performed after Durga Puja, during Lakshmi Puja)
- ✓ Dedicated to: **Goddess Mailuma and Goddess Lakshmi**
- ✓ Marks: **Harvest season**
- ✓ Unique feature: Performed standing on earthen pots, moving only lower body, with bottles balanced on head
- ✓ Nature: **Extremely difficult and skillful**

→ Dhamaal

- ✓ **Gujarat Dhamaal** Performed by **Siddhi community** (African community settled in Gujarat, brought by British as laborers/slaves)
- ✓ **Haryana Dhamaal** Linked to **Mahabharata** roots
- ✓ **Dhumal** (different from Dhamaal): Jammu & Kashmir **Watal tribe men** Started by Sufi saint **Shah Sukar Saloni** Performed on important occasions (festivals, weddings)
- ✓ **Rauf dance** from J&K Performed by **women** Known for **intricate footwork** Performed during **Eid/Ramadan/Spring festival**

⑥ Match the Folk Dances with States

Q6. Match the following traditional dances with the states they're performed in:
Thiruvathira Kali / Saila / Rauf.

Answer: Answer: 3-1-2 Option A (Kerala – Odisha – J&K)

→ Thiruvathira Kali

- ✓ State: **Kerala**
- ✓ Type: **Group dance by women**
- ✓ Costume: **Kasavu sari** (white colored sari)

- ✓ Festival: **Thiruvathira festival** (month of Dhanu); also **Onam**
- ✓ Formation: Women dance in circles around **central lamp/diya**
- ✓ Significance: Commemorates day Lord Shiva accepted Parvati as his wife

→ **Saila**

- ✓ States: **Chhattisgarh, Madhya Pradesh, and Odisha**
- ✓ Also called: **Stick Dance** (everyone holds sticks)
- ✓ Performed by: **Gond tribe**
- ✓ Occasion: **Post-harvest** (November-December, month of Agan)
- ✓ Regions in MP: **Betul, Chhindwara, Surguja district**

→ **Rauf**

- ✓ State: **Jammu & Kashmir**
- ✓ Performed by: **Women**
- ✓ Occasion: **Eid festival / Ramadan / Spring season**
- ✓ Known for: **Intricate footwork**
- ✓ Unique feature: **Wooden sticks used to pound/tap floor**
- ✓ Most notable feature: **Intricate footwork**

⑦ Bihu — Dance Celebrating the Bihu Festival

Q7. Which dance from Assam involves a group of dancers performing in circles, often accompanied by drums and pipes, to celebrate the Bihu festival?

- A** **Buguramba**
- B** **Bihu**
- C** **Dholchatom**
- D** **Hojagiri**

Answer: B — Bihu

→ **Three Types of Bihu**

Bihu Type	Also Called	Month	Season
Bohag Bihu	Rangali Bihu	March-April (Holi time)	New Year festival

Kati Bihu	Kangali Bihu	October (Kartik month)	—
Magh Bihu	Bhaugali Bihu	January (Magh month)	—

→ Bihu Dance Facts

- ✓ Both a **festival** and a **dance**
- ✓ Women's costume: **Mela Chador** (worn during Bihu dance)
- ✓ Formation: **Circles** with drums and pipes

⑧ Folk Dance of Haryana — Ghoomar

Q8. Which of the following is the folk dance of Haryana?

- ☐ A Garba
- ☒ B Ghoomar
- ☐ C Kuchipudi
- ☐ D Gidda

Answer: B — Ghoomar (also performed in Haryana, not just Rajasthan)

→ Complete Notes

- ✓ Garba **Gujarat**
- ✓ Gidda **Punjab**
- ✓ Kuchipudi **Andhra Pradesh** (Classical dance, NOT folk dance)
- ✓ Ghoomar **Rajasthan + Haryana** (folk dances can be associated with multiple states)

EXAM TRAP

IMPORTANT: Classical dances are associated with **one state only**; Folk dances can be performed in **multiple states**.

→ Other Haryana Folk Dances

- ✓ **Guga** (Haryana)
- ✓ **Luur** (Haryana)
- ✓ **Phagg** (Haryana — performed during Holi/spring season/Chaitra month)
- ✓ **Swaang/Swang** (also called Sang — also performed in Saharanpur, UP)

- ✓ **Dhamaal** (Haryana — linked to Mahabharata roots)
- ✓ **Jhumar** (Haryana version of Ghoomar)

⑨ Nagaland Victory Dance — Changlo

Q? Which dance is performed to celebrate victory over an enemy in Nagaland?

- A** Naati
- B** Heekat
- C** Malattam
- D** Changlo

Answer: D — Changlo

→ Changlo

- ✓ Also known as: **Sualua**
- ✓ Performed by: **Chang tribe**
- ✓ Occasion: **Moi Festival**
- ✓ Purpose: Celebrate victory over enemy

→ Other Options

- ✓ **Naati**: State = **Himachal Pradesh**; Regions = Shimla, Kullu, Sirmaur
- ✓ **Malattam (Mal Attam)**: States = **Tamil Nadu and Kerala** (mainly TN); also known as **Peacock Dance**; props = peacock feathers and peacock wings; performed during **Arattu festival** to honor **Lord Murugan** (= Lord Karthik, eldest son of Shiva and Parvati; worshipped more in South India)
- ✓ **Heekat**: State = **Jammu and Kashmir**; performed in **Circles**

→ Complete Nagaland Dances Table

Dance	Tribe	Special Note
Changlo (Sualua)	Chang tribe	Victory dance; Moi Festival
Aloo Yattu (A2)	Konyak tribe	—

Aau Tri (Madse)	—	—
Sacreni (Mosak Sulamani)	Mon tribe	—
Butterfly Dance	Zeliang + Angami tribe	—
Rukhyo	Lotha tribe	—
Maku He Nagchi (Maku Nagchi)	Sangtam tribe	—
Kulutsen	Yam Khang tribe	Head hunting dance
Monyashu (Monyu)	Phom Naga tribe	Performed in April

MEMORY TRICK

Memory Trick for Nagaland Dances: 'The snake is calling the butterfly, let's eat sugar and potatoes together'

- Snake Changlo
- Butterfly Butterfly Dance (Zeliang)
- Sugar Sacreni
- Potatoes Aloo Yattu
- A2 Aau Tri (Madse)

KEY FACTS

Hornbill Festival: State = Nagaland; Also called 'Festival of Festivals'; Dates = December 1st to 10th; It is BOTH a festival and a dance festival.

⑩ Mizoram Bamboo Dance — Chiraw

Q10. Which dance is performed with bamboo sticks in Mizoram?

- ☐ A Changlo
- ☐ B Ghoomar
- ☒ C Chiraw
- ☐ D Maruni

Answer: C — Chiraw

→ **Chiraw**

- ✓ State: **Mizoram**
- ✓ Also known as: **Bamboo Dance**
- ✓ How: Men hold bamboo shafts; dancers must avoid getting their feet hit between bamboos (requires great practice and synchronization)
- ✓ Festival: **Chapcharkut festival** (mainly performed during this)

→ **Maruni**

- ✓ States: **Nepal and neighboring Indian states** (Sikkim, Darjeeling, West Bengal)
- ✓ Occasion: **Tihar festival** (= Diwali)
- ✓ Originally performed to worship: **Lord Vishnu**
- ✓ Performed during: **Tihar**
- ✓ Community: **Magar community**

→ **Complete Mizoram Dances**

- ✓ **Chiraw** (Bamboo Dance) — Chapcharkut festival
- ✓ **Solakiya (Sarlamak)** — Performed by Mara community; Mizoram's victory in war dance
- ✓ **Jung Talam / Shang Lajon** — Mizoram
- ✓ **Khullam Chillam Jung** — Mizoram

⑪ Lezim — Folk Dance of Maharashtra

Q11. Lezim is a folk dance from which state?

- A** Gujarat
- B** Maharashtra
- C** Rajasthan
- D** Punjab

Answer: B — Maharashtra

MEMORY TRICK

Memory Trick: 'Kohli Kohli, bring the Vada Pav' (Vada Pav = Maharashtra)

→ **Complete Maharashtra Folk Dances**

- ✓ **Lezim** — energetic dance; featured in movie **Chhava** (about Sambhaji Maharaj, Shivaji's son)
- ✓ **Lavani** — rhythmic and sensual; percussion instrument = **Dholki**; **Baitha Kheechi** is one type; performed by Kolhati community in Tamasha troupes
- ✓ **Tamasha** — night-long folk theatre; performed in **Shimga season** (Holi time); in **Shimga/Saurashtra region**; Kolhati community linked with Tamasha troupes
- ✓ **Ashva dance** — Gujarat Kohli community also performs it
- ✓ **Dhangari Gaja**
- ✓ **Natak**
- ✓ **Mouni dance**
- ✓ **Comment dance (Kohli dance)** — fisherman (Koli) community; also in Gujarat
- ✓ **Lavani Baitha Kheechi type**

→ **Lavani Facts**

- ✓ Traditional percussion instrument: **Dholki**
- ✓ Nature: Rhythmic and sensual

⑫ UP Dance with Lighted Lamps — Charkula

Q12. Which traditional dance from Uttar Pradesh involves women carrying lighted oil lamps on their heads?

- ☐ A Bhangra
- ☐ B Gidda
- ☐ C Raasteeta
- ☒ D Charkula

Answer: D — Charkula

→ **Charkula**

- ✓ State: **Uttar Pradesh**
- ✓ Feature: **108 lamps (deepas)** placed on head
- ✓ Region: **Braj region of UP**
- ✓ Occasion: Celebrate **Radha's birth** or depict **Govardhan Leela**

→ **Raasleela**

- ✓ State: **Uttar Pradesh**
- ✓ Region: **Braj region**
- ✓ Theme: **Krishna's love stories with Radha and her friends**

→ **Other UP Folk Dances**

- ✓ **Nautanki** — UP
- ✓ **Choliya** — UP

13 Manipur Martial Dance — Thang-Ta

Q13. Which dance form in Manipur involves the use of swords, spears, and shields?

- A** Raas
- B** Thang-Ta
- C** Sankirtan
- D** Chhoom

Answer: B — Thang-Ta

→ **Thang-Ta**

- ✓ State: **Manipur**
- ✓ Type: **Martial dance / Military dance**
- ✓ Performed by: **Meitei community**
- ✓ Weapons used: **Swords, spears, shields**

→ **Other Manipur Dances**

- ✓ **Cholom (Pung Chalom)**: Manipur; Instrument = **Pung drum**; energetic; starts slow then becomes faster
- ✓ **Pheifat Lam**: Manipur; performed by **Meitei community** (same as Thang-Ta)
- ✓ **Sankirtan**: Manipur; Soft/devotional (no warrior elements)
- ✓ **Lai Haraoba**: Manipur; both a dance and a festival

→ **Other Martial Arts by State**

<i>Martial Art</i>	<i>State</i>
Gatka	Punjab
Silambam	Tamil Nadu
Kalaripayattu	Kerala
Mallakhamb	Madhya Pradesh (mainly); also Maharashtra
Pari Khanda	Bihar

⑭ Chhau Dance — Eastern India

Q14. Chhau dance is practiced in which region of India?

Answer: Eastern India — Odisha, Jharkhand, West Bengal

→ **Three Types of Chhau**

<i>Type</i>	<i>State</i>	<i>Special</i>
Purulia Chhau	West Bengal	—
Seraikela Chhau	Jharkhand	—
Mayurbhanj Chhau	Odisha	Classical martial folk dance; NO masks

KEY FACTS

Note: Chhau is a type of **martial dance**. The three types are spread across three Eastern Indian states — Odisha (Mayurbhanj, no masks), Jharkhand (Seraikela), and West Bengal (Purulia).

⑮ Raasleela — Uttar Pradesh

Q15. Raasleela is a traditional dance of which state?

Answer: Uttar Pradesh (Braj region)

→ **Complete Notes**

- ✓ **Raasleela**: State = **Uttar Pradesh**
 - ✓ Region: **Braj region** (Mathura/Vrindavan area)
 - ✓ Theme: **Krishna's love stories with Radha and her friends**
 - ✓ Other UP dances: **Charkula, Nautanki, Choliya**
 - ✓ Raasleela is closely tied to Krishna bhakti tradition of Braj
-

⑩ Shikar Dance — Gujarat

Q16. Shikar dance is traditionally from which Indian state?

Answer: Gujarat

→ **Complete Notes**

- ✓ **Shikar** = hunting (hunting traditions are shown)
 - ✓ Region: **Dharampur region, Gujarat**
-

⑪ Gujarat Folk Dances — Complete List

Q17. Complete list of Gujarat folk dances.

Answer: 12 major folk dances of Gujarat

→ **Complete Gujarat Folk Dances**

- ✓ **Garba** — Before Aarti, Navratri; women in circles around Garbhadeep
- ✓ **Dandiya Raas** — After Aarti; sticks used; mock fight Durga vs Mahishasura
- ✓ **Tipani** — Women tap floor with wooden sticks; men play Dhol-Nagada; from **Saurashtra region**; performed by hard-working people
- ✓ **Comment (Kohli dance)** — Stick dance; **Chorwad district** of Gujarat; Kohli (fisherman) community
- ✓ **Siddhi Dhamaal** — Performed by **Siddhi community** (African community in Gujarat)
- ✓ **Bhavai** — Gujarat
- ✓ **Padhar dance** — Nal Sarovar area, Ahmedabad (Padhar community)

- ✓ *Hudo* — Gujarat
- ✓ *Shikar dance* — Dharampur region
- ✓ *Dangi dance* — Dang district of Gujarat; performed by **Bhilur/Dangi tribals**; group dance (NOT solo)
- ✓ *Manjira dance* — Padhar community; Nal Sarovar area, Ahmedabad
- ✓ *Ashva dance* — Kohli community

18 Manjira Dance — Padhar Community

Q18. *Manjira dance is performed by which community in Gujarat?*

- ☒ A *Padhar community*
- ☐ B ~~*Mappila community*~~

Answer: A — Padhar community

→ [Complete Notes](#)

- ✓ **Location:** Nal Sarovar area, Ahmedabad, Gujarat
- ✓ Padhar community also performs other traditional Gujarat folk dances
- ✓ Mappila = Kerala Muslim community (performs Uppana dance at weddings)

19 Ladakhi Dance — Koshan (Horse Race)

Q19. *Which Ladakhi dance is performed in Leh and is preceded by a horse race?*

- ☐ A ~~*Sikmari*~~
- ☒ B *Koshan*
- ☐ C ~~*Mamita*~~
- ☐ D ~~*Lezim*~~

Answer: B — Koshan

Memory Trick: Kushans (Central Asian tribe, Kanishka) came on horseback
remember horse race connection

→ Complete Ladakh Dances

- ✓ **Koshan** — Leh; preceded by horse race
- ✓ **Shaan-Doll (Shono-Dol)** — Called **Royal Dance of Ladakh**; performed by **Taksham** (highly skilled female dancers)
- ✓ **Jabra dance** — Performed by **Changpa community** of **Changthang Plateau**; very high energy; performed during **Losar festival** (New Year of Tibetan Buddhist community)
- ✓ **Spau** — **Warrior dance**; dedicated to **Gyalpokesar** (warrior); performed in Ladakh UT
- ✓ **Cham dance** — **Sacred Mask dance** (performed in monasteries); Hemis Festival (Ladakh); also in Sikkim

→ Mamita

- ✓ State: **Tripura**
- ✓ Performed by: **Kaloi community / Kaloi tribe**
- ✓ Occasion: **Harvest time**

→ Sikmari

- ✓ State: **Sikkim**
- ✓ Performed by: **Lepcha tribe**
- ✓ Occasion: **Harvest time**

→ Losar Festival

- ✓ New Year festival of **Tibetan Buddhist community**
- ✓ Celebrated in: **Sikkim, Ladakh, Himachal Pradesh, Arunachal Pradesh**

②0 Tamil Nadu Dance for Goddess Mariamman — Karakattam

Q20. Which dance is performed in front of an image of Goddess Mariamman (Rain Goddess) in Tamil Nadu?

- A Karakattam
- B Villu Pattu
- C Sevai Attam
- D Kolattam

Answer: A — Karakattam

→ Complete Tamil Nadu Folk Dances

Dance	Details
Karakattam	Performed for Goddess Mariamman (Rain Goddess)
Villu Pattu	Tamil Nadu and Kerala; Bow song (large bow instrument used); called Villu = bow
Sevai Attam	Service to God; honors Lord Tirumala (incarnation of Vishnu); Naicker community
Kolattam	Stick dance; AP, TN, Kerala
Kummi dance	Women in circles clapping; Tamil Nadu and Kerala
Pulikali	Tiger dance ; depicts tiger hunting; Kerala; performed during Onam festival
Kavadi Attam	Dedicated to Lord Murugan ; bamboo carried on shoulders; devotees pierce body with Murugan's spear during festival
Poikkal Kuthirai Attam	Dummy horse dance ; mainly Tamil Nadu; horse with no legs (dummy); person fits inside
Bommalattam	Puppet dance depicting scenes from Ramayana and Mahabharata; Tamil Nadu

→ Natyanjali Dance Festival

- ✓ Celebrated in: **Chidambaram, Tamil Nadu**
- ✓ Dedicated to: **Lord Nataraja** (cosmic dancer form of Lord Shiva)

- ✓ Occasion: **Mahashivratri** (in all Shiva temples); also Chidambaram temple festival
- ✓ Both a dance and a festival (like Bihu, Lai Haraoba)

21 Himachal Pradesh Dance — Chhatari

Q21. Which of the following is related to Himachal Pradesh?

- A ~~Pheifat Lam~~
- B ~~Garia~~
- C ~~Hojagiri~~
- D **Chhatari**

Answer: D — Chhatari

→ Complete Notes

- ✓ **Chhatari** Village in Himachal Pradesh Chamba Valley **Gaddi tribe** performs it
- ✓ **Pheifat Lam** Manipur (Meitei community)
- ✓ **Garia** Tripura (performed during Garia Puja)
- ✓ **Hojagiri** Tripura (performed during Hojagiri festival)

→ Complete Himachal Pradesh Folk Dances

- ✓ **Gaddi Naati** — Bharmour, Chamba Valley; Gaddi tribe
- ✓ **Chhatari** — Chamba Valley; Gaddi tribe
- ✓ **Naati** — Shimla, Kullu, Sirmaur regions
- ✓ **Nati** — HP
- ✓ **Jhumar** Haryana version (different from Jharkhand Jhumar)
- ✓ **Shand-Shabu** — Lahaul Valley; dedicated to **Lord Buddha**
- ✓ **Dangi dance** — Not HP (Gujarat)

22 Jago Dance — Punjab Wedding Dance

Q22. Jago dance is related to which state?

- ☒ A Punjab
- ☐ B Jharkhand
- ☐ C Odisha
- ☐ D Maharashtra

Answer: A — Punjab

→ Complete Notes — Jago

- ✓ Meaning: 'Wake up' (a wake-up call)
- ✓ Occasion: Weddings
- ✓ Performed by: Women
- ✓ Props: Brass vessel decorated with lamps and flowers — carried on head
- ✓ State: Punjab

→ Complete Punjab Folk Dances

- ✓ Bhangra — Most famous; instrument = Dhol; Sandalbar region
- ✓ Gidda — Women only; Teej and Lohri; sing Boliyan; circle formation
- ✓ Jago — Wedding ceremony; women carry decorated brass vessel on head
- ✓ Luddi — Popular in Punjab; Sandalbar region

23 Mizoram War Victory Dance — Solakiya

Q23. Which traditional dance of Mizoram is performed to celebrate victory in war?

- ☐ A Kodava
- ☐ B Chamba
- ☐ C Dhumal
- ☒ D Solakiya

Answer: D — Solakiya

→ Complete Notes

- ✓ **Solakiya** — Also called **Sarlamak**; mainly **Mara community** of Mizoram; victory in war dance
- ✓ **Kodava** — Karnataka; Coorg district; **warrior dance**; Kodava community performs it
- ✓ **Chamba** — Himachal Pradesh
- ✓ **Dhumal** — J&K; **Watal tribe men**; started by Sufi saint **Shah Sukar Saloni**

②④ **Ranappa — Odisha Martial Dance**

Q24. *Ranappa is a martial dance associated with which Indian state?*

- ☐ A **Haryana**
- ☐ B **Rajasthan**
- ☐ C **Manipur**
- ☒ D **Odisha**

Answer: D — Odisha

→ **Complete Notes**

- ✓ **Ranappa** — Originated in **Ganjam district, Odisha**
- ✓ Related to: **Paika martial tradition** (also from Odisha)
- ✓ Performance: Dancers **stand on bamboo sticks** (called **Ranappa**) while dancing
- ✓ Associated with: Life of **Lord Krishna**
- ✓ Type: **Martial dance** (high-energy movements)

MEMORY TRICK

Memory Trick for Odisha: 'Ate Pua, ate Dal, danda lekar ghoom'

- Pua**Gotipua**
- Dal**Dalkhai**
- Danda**Danda Nacha**
- Ghoom**Ghumura**

→ **Complete Odisha Folk Dances**

- ✓ **Gotipua** Boys perform; Krishna/Jagannath Leela narratives (**Pua Gotipua**)
- ✓ **Dalkhai** Women; Western Odisha; shows Radha-Krishna love stories
- ✓ **Danda Nacha** (Danda)

- ✓ **Ghumura** Kalahandi region (Ghumura Ghumura)
- ✓ **Bhaag Nacha** (Bhaag)
- ✓ **Chhau** Martial dance (three types)
- ✓ **Paika** Martial dance; Khandayat warrior caste
- ✓ **Ranappa** Ganjam district; bamboo sticks
- ✓ **Salpuri** Sambalpur district; performed during **Nuakhai festival**; very energetic with anklets
- ✓ **Suangam**

②5 Swang Dance — Uttar Pradesh (originally Haryana)

Q25. Swang dance is performed in which Indian state?

- ☐ A Goa
- ☐ B Kerala
- ☐ C Karnataka
- ☒ D Uttar Pradesh

Answer: D — Uttar Pradesh (correct answer given; originally from Haryana, also in Saharanpur UP)

→ Complete Notes

- ✓ **Swang/Sang** — Originally **Haryana**; also performed in **Saharanpur district of UP** (shares border with Haryana)
- ✓ **Guga** — Haryana
- ✓ **Phagg/Fagg** — Haryana; performed during **Holi** (spring season, Chaitra month)

②6 Pandav Dance — Uttarakhand

Q26. Pandav dance performed during Dussehra and Diwali belongs to which Indian state?

- ☐ A Assam
- ☐ B Maharashtra
- ☒ C Uttarakhand
- ☐ D Karnataka

Answer: C — Uttarakhand

→ **Complete Notes**

- ✓ **Pandav dance** — Garhwal and Kumaon regions of Uttarakhand
- ✓ **Theme: Narrates stories from Mahabharata** (battle between Kauravas and Pandavas)

→ **Complete Uttarakhand Folk Dances**

- ✓ **Pandav dance** — Mahabharata stories; Garhwal and Kumaon
- ✓ **Chholiya** — Kumaon region; **sword dance**; martial style; performed at weddings
- ✓ **Chhapeli** — Uttarakhand
- ✓ **Jhora** — Kumaon; men and women in **mixed circles** during spring fairs; accompanied by **Harka drum**; performed on **full moon night around Holi**
- ✓ **Chanchari** — Uttarakhand
- ✓ **Langveer dance** — Uttarakhand
- ✓ **Thodiya** — Performed at time of **marriages**

②7 Sikkim Dance — Snow Lion (Singhi Chham)

Q27. Which of the following is a traditional dance associated with the culture of Sikkim?

- A *Luur*
- B *Dindi*
- C *Padhar*
- D **Snow Lion (Singhi Chham)**

Answer: D — Snow Lion (Singhi Chham)

→ **Complete Notes**

- ✓ **Snow Lion** = Also called **Singhi Chham dance** = **Sacred Mask dance**
- ✓ Performed during: **Losar festival** (local New Year)
- ✓ **Luur** Haryana
- ✓ **Padhar** Nal Sarovar, Ahmedabad, Gujarat
- ✓ **Dindi** Marathwada region, Maharashtra; performed in **Kartik month**

→ **Complete Sikkim Folk Dances**

- ✓ **Sikmari** — Lepcha tribe; harvest time
- ✓ **Cham dance** — Mask dance; monasteries
- ✓ **Snow Lion (Singhi Chham)** — Losar festival; Sacred Mask Dance
- ✓ **Ghantu** — Sikkim
- ✓ **Chuphat** — Sikkim
- ✓ **Maruni** — Magar community; Tihar festival (also in Darjeeling, West Bengal)
- ✓ **Kanchenjunga** — India's highest peak in Sikkim; **worshipped** here

②⑧ **Garia Dance — Tripura**

Q28. In which Indian state is the Garia dance traditionally performed?

- ☐ A Gujarat
- ☐ B Jharkhand
- ☐ C Maharashtra
- ☒ D Tripura

Answer: D — Tripura

→ **Complete Tripura Folk Dances**

- ✓ **Garia** — Performed during **Garia Puja**
- ✓ **Hojagiri** — Bru Reang community; Hojagiri festival; earthen pots; lower body movement; bottles on head; dedicated to Goddess Mailuma and Lakshmi
- ✓ **Lebang Bhumani** — Also called **Bumbu dance**; Lebang = insect; performed when crops sown to drive away insects
- ✓ **Mamita** — Kaloï community; harvest time
- ✓ **Hai Haq** — Tripura
- ✓ **Mosak Sulamani/Sulaimani/Sumani** — Tripura

29 Badhai Dance — Madhya Pradesh

Q29. Badhai is a famous dance performed in which Indian state?

- ☐ A Assam
- ☐ B Andhra Pradesh
- ☒ C Madhya Pradesh
- ☐ D Gujarat

Answer: C — Madhya Pradesh

→ **Complete Notes**

- ✓ **Badhai** — Bundelkhand region of MP (Banda, Chitrakoot areas)
- ✓ Occasion: **Childbirth and Marriage ceremonies**
- ✓ Dedicated to: **Goddess Shitala Mata** (thanked for child's birth and marriages)

→ Complete Andhra Pradesh Folk Dances

- ✓ **Lambadi** — Performed by **Banjara tribe**; colorful costumes; integral to **wedding rituals**
- ✓ **Dhimsa** — **Araku Valley** (Visakhapatnam); performed by tribal communities
- ✓ **Veeranatyam** — 'Song of Bravery'; dance of warriors
- ✓ **Vilasini Natyam** — Temple and court dance; almost extinct; **revived by Swapna Sundari**; Devadasis perform in temples; State: Andhra Pradesh
- ✓ **Butta Bamalu** — AP
- ✓ **Dappu** — AP and Telangana; **Mala and Madiga communities** perform; instrument = **Dappli**
- ✓ **Gusadi** — Gond tribe performs
- ✓ **Dandariya** — Gond tribe performs
- ✓ **Yakshagana** — Karnataka (also AP — folk dances can be in multiple states)
- ✓ **Burrakatha** — Instrument = **Tamboura**

30 Island Dance — Arunachal Pradesh

Q30. Island dance is traditionally performed by tribes belonging to which Indian states?

- A Goa
- B Odisha
- C Jharkhand
- D Arunachal Pradesh

Answer: D — Arunachal Pradesh

→ Complete Notes

- ✓ **Island dance** — Performed by **Adi tribe**; during **Solung festival**

MEMORY TRICK

Memory Trick: 'Rekha ji is talking to Aruna ji — Hey Laamu, let's go to Vancho Bua's place with Pasi Konki, and watch Lawn and Peacock dance'

→ Complete Arunachal Pradesh Folk Dances

<i>Dance</i>	<i>Tribe/Note</i>
Rekampada	—
Aji Laamu	—
Vancho	Wancho tribe war dance during Oriah festival
Baiya	—
Pasi Konki	—
Chalo	—
Lawn dance	—
Peacock dance	—
Popper	—
Island dance	Adi tribe; Solung festival
Ojie	Galo tribe; performed during Mopin festival

→ **Wancho Tribe Special**

- ✓ War dance performed during: **Oriah festival** (NOT Hornbill — that's Nagaland)
- ✓ The dance = also called **unity dance** (showcases unity of Wancho community)

31 Rai Dance — Madhya Pradesh

Q31. Rai is a famous folk dance performed by which Indian state?

- A** Madhya Pradesh
- B** Punjab
- C** Odisha
- D** Assam

Answer: A — Madhya Pradesh

→ **Complete Notes**

- ✓ **Rai** — Bundelkhand region of MP
- ✓ Performed mainly by: **Women** (called **Bedni**)
- ✓ Famous exponent: **Ram Sahay Pandey** (awarded **Padma Shri**; passed away in **2025**)
- ✓ Men's role: Perform in **women's attire** (disguise)

32) Paricha Kali — Lakshadweep Shield Dance

Q32. Which folk dance of Lakshadweep is also known as the Shield Dance?

- ☐ A ~~Saila (Odisha)~~
- ☐ B ~~Gambhira (West Bengal)~~
- ☒ C **Paricha Kali**
- ☐ D ~~Yasham (Arunachal Pradesh)~~

Answer: C — Paricha Kali

→ Paricha Kali

- ✓ State: **Lakshadweep** (performed in **Minicoy** island)
- ✓ Type: **Shield dance / Warrior dance**
- ✓ Community: **Muslim community** (main population of Lakshadweep)

→ Complete Lakshadweep Dances

- ✓ **Paricha Kali** — Shield dance; Minicoy
- ✓ **Lava dance** — Minicoy island
- ✓ **Kolkali** — Stick dance; performed in **Lakshadweep and Kerala**; Muslim community
- ✓ **Bandiya** — Minicoy; Lakshadweep

→ West Bengal Folk Dances

- ✓ **Gambhira** — West Bengal
- ✓ **Jhumur** — Tea gardens
- ✓ **Purulia Chhau** — Martial dance
- ✓ **Raibanshi** — West Bengal
- ✓ **Dammi dance** — West Bengal

- ✓ **Tusu** — West Bengal
 - ✓ **Britha** — West Bengal
 - ✓ **Baul** — West Bengal (also a folk song form)
-

33 Talangalam — Mizoram

Q33. Talangalam is a famous dance performed in which state/UT?

- A** Mizoram
- B** Kerala
- C** Himachal Pradesh
- D** Jammu & Kashmir

Answer: A — Mizoram

→ Complete Notes

- ✓ **Talangalam** — Mizoram; performed during **Chapcharkut festival**

→ Complete Kerala Folk Dances

- ✓ **Theyyam** — North Malabar; Kannur, Kasargod; Kaliyattam festival
 - ✓ **Thiruvathira Kali** — Thiruvathira festival; Kasavu sari; central lamp
 - ✓ **Uppana** — Mappila community; marriages
 - ✓ **Kolkali** — Stick dance; also in Lakshadweep
 - ✓ **Ottam Thullal** — Created by **Kunchan Nambiar**
 - ✓ **Kudiyattam** — Kerala
 - ✓ **Kummi dance** — Women in circles; also Tamil Nadu
 - ✓ **Malattam** — Peacock dance; also Tamil Nadu
 - ✓ **Pulikali** — Tiger dance; Onam festival
 - ✓ **Kavadi Attam** — Lord Murugan
-

34 Dekhni Dance — Goa

Q34. Which Indian state is famous for the folk dance Dekhni?

Answer: Goa

→ **Complete Notes**

- ✓ **Dekhni** — Performed by **Devadasis** (young women devoted to temples)
- ✓ **Props: Lamp in hands**

→ **Complete Goa Folk Dances**

- ✓ **Dekhni** — Devadasis; lamp in hands
- ✓ **Fugdi** — Performed during **Ganesh Chaturthi**
- ✓ **Dhalo** — Goa
- ✓ **Kunbi** — Goa
- ✓ **Ghode Modni** — Warrior dance; Goa
- ✓ **Romat** — Performed during **Shigmo festival**
- ✓ **Chikal Kalo** — Mud festival of Goa

③⑤ Jhoda Dance — Uttarakhand

Q35. Jhoda dance performed on a full moon night around Holi belongs to which Indian state?

Answer: Uttarakhand (Kumaon region)

→ **Complete Notes**

- ✓ **Jhoda/Jhora**: Kumaon region, Uttarakhand
- ✓ Men & women in **mixed circles** during spring fairs
- ✓ Accompanied by **Harka drum**
- ✓ Performed on **full moon night around Holi**
- ✓ Participants hold each other's **arms/hands**

③⑥ Spau — Ladakh Warrior Dance

Q36. Spau is a warrior dance performed in which Indian state and UT?

- ☒ A Ladakh
- ☐ B Goa
- ☐ C Himachal Pradesh
- ☐ D J&K

Answer: A — Ladakh

→ Complete Notes

- ✓ Spau — Warrior dance from Ladakh
- ✓ Dedicated to: Gyalpokesar (warrior)
- ✓ Performed by: Changpa community of Changthang Plateau

37 Luddi Dance — Punjab

Q37. The dance form Luddi is popular in which Indian state?

- ☐ A Rajasthan
- ☒ B Punjab
- ☐ C Gujarat
- ☐ D Haryana

Answer: B — Punjab

→ Complete Notes

- ✓ Luddi — Punjab; performed in Sandalbar region of Punjab
- ✓ Shares Sandalbar region with Bhangra

38 Veergase — Karnataka

Q38. Veergase is a traditional folk dance of which Indian state?

Answer: Karnataka

→ **Complete Notes**

- ✓ **Veergase** — Karnataka
- ✓ Performed by: **Veerashaiva (Lingayat) community** (devotees of Lord Shiva; wear Shiva Linga as garland)
- ✓ Dedicated to: **Lord Veerabhadra** (form of Shiva)
- ✓ Nature: **Fierce/warrior-type dance**

→ **Complete Karnataka Folk Dances**

- ✓ **Veergase** — Veerashaiva/Lingayat community; Lord Veerabhadra
- ✓ **Yakshagana** — Combines dance, music, dialogue, costume and stage techniques; unique style
- ✓ **Dollu Kunita** — Drum dance; cylindrical drums; Kurba community performs it
- ✓ **Huli Vessa** — Tiger dance
- ✓ **Kodava dance** — Warrior dance; Coorg/Kodagu district; Kodava community
- ✓ **Somana Kunita** — Karnataka
- ✓ **Goravara/Gowara Kunita** — Karnataka
- ✓ **Kamsale** — Karnataka

KEY FACTS

Memory Trick: Wherever you see 'Kunita' it's from Karnataka

③9 Kummi Dance — Tamil Nadu (Women Clapping in Circle)

Q39. Which traditional dance of Tamil Nadu is performed by women dancing in a circle while clapping their hands to the rhythm?

- A Kummi dance**
- ~~B Tasu dance~~
- ~~C Gidda dance~~
- ~~D Kathi dance~~

Answer: A — Kummi dance

→ Complete Notes

- ✓ **Kummi** — Tamil Nadu and Kerala; women in circles; hand clapping
- ✓ **Tasu** — Chota Nagpur Plateau, **Jharkhand**; Kurmi community
- ✓ **Kathi** — **Nimad region, MP**; performed to worship Shiva and Parvati
- ✓ **Gidda** — Punjab

④① Tera Tali / 13 Taali — Rajasthan

Q40. In which state is the 13 Taali / Tera Tali dance traditionally performed?

- A Rajasthan**
- B MP
- C Gujarat
- D Haryana

Answer: A — Rajasthan

→ Tera Tali (13 Taali)

- ✓ State: **Rajasthan**
- ✓ Tribe: **Kamada tribe**
- ✓ Region: **Marwar region, Rajasthan**
- ✓ Dedicated to: **Baba Ramdev** (not the Patanjali Baba Ramdev; another Baba Ramdev of Rajasthan)

→ Taratali (similar name, different state)

- ✓ State: **Madhya Pradesh**
- ✓ Tribe: **Kamar tribe**
- ✓ Also involves 13 claps (similar concept, different state)

→ Complete Rajasthan Folk Dances

- ✓ **Ghoomar** — Bhil tribe (originally); Rajput community (later); Navratri, Teej, Gangaur
- ✓ **Kalbelia** — **Snake (Sapera) tribe**; black flowing skirts; mirror embroidery; **UNESCO ICH 2010**; famous exponent = **Gulabo Sapera**
- ✓ **Tera Tali / 13 Taali** — Kamada tribe; Baba Ramdev; Marwar region

- ✓ *Ghudla dance* — Rajasthan
- ✓ *Kachchi Ghodi* — Rajasthan
- ✓ *Bam dance* — Rajasthan

④① *Monyashu* — Nagaland

Q41. In which state is Monyashu practiced?

Answer: Nagaland

→ *Complete Notes*

- ✓ *Monyashu (Monyu)* — Performed by *Phom Naga* tribe
- ✓ Performed in *April*
- ✓ Part of Nagaland's rich tribal dance traditions (along with *Changlo*, *Aloo Yattu*, *Butterfly Dance*, etc.)

④② *Gotipua Nacha* — Odisha

Q42. Gotipua Nacha is performed in which state?

Answer: Odisha

MEMORY TRICK

Memory Trick: 'Ate Pua, ate Dal, danda lekar ghoom' Pua = *Gotipua*, Dal = *Dalkhai*, Danda = *Danda Nacha*, Ghoom = *Ghumura*

④③ *Himachal Pradesh Dance* — *Shand-Shabu*

Q43. Which of the following popular dances is from Himachal Pradesh?

- ☐ A ~~Fugdi (Goa)~~
- ☐ B ~~Sattriya (Assam — Classical dance)~~
- ☐ C ~~Jhumar~~
- ☒ D **Shand-Shabu**

Answer: D — Shand-Shabu

→ **Complete Notes**

- ✓ **Shand-Shabu** — Lahaul Valley, HP; dedicated to Lord Buddha
- ✓ **Sattriya** — Classical dance from Assam; NOT folk dance; performed wearing white clothes

→ **Jhumar vs Ghoomar vs Jhumur — Important Comparison**

Name	State/Region
Jhumar	Haryana (also called Ghoomar in Haryana)
Ghoomar	Rajasthan (and Haryana)
Jhumur	East India — Assam/West Bengal tea gardens; also Jharkhand/Odisha (called Jhumer there)

④④ **Bommallattam — Tamil Nadu Puppet Dance**

Q44. Which traditional puppet dance of Tamil Nadu depicts scenes from Ramayana and Mahabharata?

- ☐ A ~~Ghotul (Chhattisgarh)~~
- ☐ B ~~Paricha Kali (Lakshadweep)~~
- ☒ C **Bommallattam**
- ☐ D ~~Bandiya (Lakshadweep)~~

Answer: C — Bommallattam

→ **Complete Notes**

- ✓ **Bommallattam** — Tamil Nadu; puppet dance; depicts scenes from **Ramayana** and **Mahabharata**
 - ✓ **Ghotul** — Chhattisgarh; Bastar region; tribal education/social institution of **Maria tribe** (where education is imparted and couples meet)
-

④⑤ **Jhijhia Dance — Bihar**

Q45. Jhijhia dance is related to which Indian state?

Answer: Bihar

→ **Complete Bihar Folk Dances**

- ✓ **Jat-Jatin** — Bihar
 - ✓ **Jhijhia** — Mithila region; performed by women during **Navratri**; dedicated to **Goddess Durga**; pot balanced on head
 - ✓ **Videshiya** — Bhojpuri folk dance; created by **Bhikhari Thakur** (**Shakespeare of Bihar**)
 - ✓ **Launda Naach** — Men **cross-dress as women**; entertaining audiences during festivals
 - ✓ **Jharni** — Bihar
 - ✓ **Damkach** — Bihar
 - ✓ **Paika** — Also in Bihar (mainly Odisha/Jharkhand)
 - ✓ **Jhumri** — Bihar
 - ✓ **Karma** — Also in Jharkhand
 - ✓ **Kajri** — Jharkhand, Odisha; performed to **welcome monsoon**
-

④⑥ **Sua Dance — Chhattisgarh Parrot Dance**

Q46. Which folk dance of Chhattisgarh is also known as the Parrot Dance?

- ☐ A Aaling Mongyu (Nagaland)
- ☐ B Kolattam (AP)
- ☐ C Lambadi (AP)
- ☒ D Sua dance

Answer: D — Sua

→ Complete Chhattisgarh Folk Dances

MEMORY TRICK

Memory Trick: 'Kassar Abujh Maria, instead of doing Karma, let's hit Gadiya at night and do Panthi Pagalpanthi'

Dance	Performer/Details
Sua (Parrot Dance)	Performed like a parrot (Sua = parrot)
Karma dance	Karma festival; Bhadra Ekadashi
Raut dance	Yadav community
Gadi Nritya	Bamboo sticks used; night dance
Panthi	Satnami community; Guru Ghasidas Amritvani; white dhoti worn; dedicated to Guru Ghasidas; Padma Vibhushan 2019 = Teejan Bai
Saila	Gond tribe; stick dance
Pandavani	Narrates Mahabharata tales through dance; famous exponent = Teejan Bai (Padma Shri + Padma Vibhushan 2019)
Bison Horn Maria	Dandami Maria tribe; Bastar

④7 Kakkassu Natakam — Kerala

Q47. *Kakrassi Natakam is a satirical dance drama of which Indian state?*

- ☐ A Gujarat
- ☒ B Kerala
- ☐ C Maharashtra
- ☐ D Tripura

Answer: B — Kerala

④8 Nautanki — Uttar Pradesh

Q48. *Where is Nautanki from?*

Answer: Uttar Pradesh

→ **Complete Notes**

- ✓ **Nautanki, Raasleela, Charkula** — All from **Uttar Pradesh**
- ✓ **Nautanki** = folk theatre tradition of UP

④9 Dhumal — Statements (CGL 2025)

Q49. *Consider statements about Dhumal:*

S1: Dhumal is exclusively performed by Watal men of Jammu and Kashmir.

S2: It celebrates the apple harvest in J&K.

Answer: Only Statement 1 is correct

→ **Explanation**

- ✓ **Statement 1** — Watal tribe men of J&K perform Dhumal (started by Sufi saint **Shah Sukar Saloni**)
- ✓ **Statement 2** — Not for apple harvest; performed on **important occasions** (festivals, weddings)

50) Perini Shiva Tandavam — Statements (CGL 2025)

Q50. Statements about Perini Shiva Tandavam:

S1: Perini Shiva Tandavam is a warrior dance revived in modern times.

S2: It originated from the court of Chola Kings.

Answer: Only Statement 1 is correct

→ Explanation

- ✓ **Statement 1** — It IS a warrior dance; revived by Dr. Nataraja Ramakrishna
- ✓ **Statement 2** — Originated from **Kakatiya Dynasty** (NOT Chola Kings)

(51) Wancho Tribe — War Dance Festival

Q51. The Wancho tribe of Arunachal Pradesh performs a war dance during which festival?

- A** Hornbill
- B** ~~Chaloku (Nok tribe — NOT Wancho)~~
- C** Oriah
- D** ~~Mopin (Galo tribe)~~

Answer: C — Oriah

→ Complete Notes

- ✓ **Wancho tribe** war dance during **Oriah festival**
- ✓ Wancho dance = **unity dance** (showcases community unity)
- ✓ **Chaloku** Nok tribe performs (NOT Wancho)
- ✓ **Ojie dance** Galo tribe **Mopin festival**
- ✓ **Hornbill Festival** Nagaland (NOT Arunachal)

(52) Panthi Dance — Statements

Q52. Which of the following statements is/are correct about Panthi dance?

S1: Panthi steps accompany teachings from Guru Ghasidas Amritvani.

S2: The mask represents a virtuous man born in high ritual versions.

Answer: A — Only Statement 1 is correct

→ **Explanation**

- ✓ **Statement 1** — Amritvani = compilation of Guru Ghasidas's teachings; showcased in Panthi dance steps
- ✓ **Statement 2** — Panthi is NOT a mask dance

(53) Karma Dance — Statements

Q53. Statements about Karma dance:

S1: The ritual honors the Karma Tree on Bhadra Ekadashi in Chhattisgarh.

S2: The drum most associated with it is the Modal (played with hands).

Answer: C — Both are correct

→ **Complete Notes**

- ✓ Karma dance performed during **Karma festival**
- ✓ Also performed in: **Jharkhand, Odisha** (not just Chhattisgarh)
- ✓ Drum: **Modal** (played with hands)

(54) Dangi Dance — Statements

Q54. Statements about Dangi dance:

S1: Performed by Dangi tribals of Dang district, Gujarat.

S2: The dance is a solo narrative form.

Answer: A — Only Statement 1 is correct

→ **Explanation**

- ✓ **Statement 1** — Dang district, Gujarat; Dangi/Bhilur tribe

- ✓ **Statement 2** — NOT solo; it's a GROUP dance

(55) Maruni Dance — Sikkim Weddings

Q55. Which dance is performed during Sikkim weddings?

- ☒ A Maruni
- ☐ B Chhau
- ☐ C Gidda
- ☐ D Lavani

Answer: A — Maruni

→ Complete Notes

- ✓ **Maruni:** Magar community; Tihar festival = **Diwali**; Sikkim, Darjeeling, West Bengal
- ✓ Originally performed to worship **Lord Vishnu**
- ✓ Performed during **Tihar**
- ✓ Community: **Magar community**

(56) Dash Dance — Himachal Pradesh (Rajputs)

Q56. Fill in the blank — Dash dance is performed mostly by which community?

- ☒ A Rajputs
- ☐ B Brahmins
- ☐ C Jats
- ☐ D Ahirs

Answer: A — Rajputs

→ Complete Notes

- ✓ **Dash dance** — Himachal Pradesh; performed by **Rajputs**

- ✓ Regions: **Sirmaur** and other places in HP
 - ✓ Theme: Battle between **Kauravas and Pandavas** (Mahabharata) depicted in dance
-

(57) Vilasini Natyam — Andhra Pradesh

Q57. Vilasini Natyam, once performed in temples and courts, has been revived in which Indian state?

- ☐ A ~~Tamil Nadu~~
- ☒ B **Andhra Pradesh**
- ☐ C ~~Karnataka~~
- ☐ D ~~Kerala~~

Answer: B — Andhra Pradesh

→ Complete Notes

- ✓ **Vilasini Natyam** — Andhra Pradesh; performed by **Devadasis** in temples
 - ✓ Revived by: **Swapna Sundari** (it was almost extinct)
-

(58) Dhumal Dance — Unique Feature

Q58. Which statement correctly describes a unique feature of the Dhumal dance of Kashmir?

Answer: C — Performed by Watal tribe men; they wear very well-robbed/beautiful costumes

→ Explanation

- ✓ Only men perform it (NOT anyone in any outfit)
 - ✓ Performed in **groups** (NOT solo)
 - ✓ Watal tribe men; **elaborate/beautiful robes**
-

(59) Kalbelia — Statements

Q59. Statements about Kalbelia:

S1: Female costumes are black flowing skirts richly mirror-embroidered.

S2: Performances are rarely documented due to oral nomadic heritage.

S3: The community's art was included in UNESCO's ICH list without any written application process.

Answer: A — Only Statement 1 is correct

→ Explanation

- ✓ **Statement 1** — Black, flowing, mirror-embroidered skirts
- ✓ **Statement 2** — Could be considered; oral tradition is correct
- ✓ **Statement 3** — Extreme keyword 'without any written application process' **WRONG**; formal application process was required; included in **UNESCO ICH list in 2010**
- ✓ Famous exponent: **Gulabo Sopera**

(60) Jhora Dance — What Participants Hold

Q60. In Jhora dance, participants hold each other by the _____.

- ☐ A Waist
- ☒ B Arms/Hands
- ☐ C Shoulders
- ☐ D Neck

Answer: B — Arms/Hands

→ Complete Notes

- ✓ **Jhora** — Kumaon, Uttarakhand
- ✓ Formation: **Mixed circle** (men and women)
- ✓ Hold: **Each other's arms/hands**
- ✓ Accompanied by **Harka drum**
- ✓ Performed on **full moon night around Holi**

(61) Tipani / Comment Dance — Origin Region

Q61. The Comment (Tipani) dance originates from which region of Gujarat?

Answer: Saurashtra region

→ Complete Notes

- ✓ Tipani/Comment — Saurashtra region, Gujarat
 - ✓ Women tap the floor with wooden sticks
 - ✓ Men play Dhol-Nagada
 - ✓ Performed by hard-working people of Saurashtra
-

(62) Dhumal Dancers — What They Wear

Q62. Dhumal dance dancers wear _____ during the performance.

Answer: Colorful robes (well-robed/beautiful costumes)

→ Complete Notes

- ✓ Watal tribe men wear elaborate, colorful robes
 - ✓ Dhumal = J&K, started by Sufi saint Shah Sukar Saloni
 - ✓ Performed on important occasions (festivals, weddings)
-

(63) Ghoomar — Statements

Q63. Statements about Ghoomar:

S1: Its earliest performers are Bhil women.

S2: Ghoomar was included in UNESCO's list of Intangible Cultural Heritage in 2015.

Answer: A — Only Statement 1 is correct

→ Explanation

- ✓ **Statement 1** — Initially performed by **Bhil women** (to worship Goddess Saraswati)
- ✓ **Statement 2** — **Ghoomar** has **NEVER** been included in UNESCO ICH list; **Kalbelia** was included in **2010** (not Ghoomar, not 2015)

EXAM TRAP

Do NOT confuse Ghoomar with Kalbelia on the UNESCO list. **Ghoomar NEVER** listed; **Kalbelia** in **2010**.

(64) Secret Mask Dance — Hemis Festival

Q64. The secret mask dance performed at Hemis Festival represents which deity?

Answer: Guardian divinities (protector deities)

→ **Complete Notes**

- ✓ **Hemis Festival** — Performed in **monasteries** in **Ladakh**
- ✓ Masks represent: **Guardian divinities** (protector deities)
- ✓ Also: **Hemis National Park** is in **Ladakh**
- ✓ Also found in: **Cham dance** of **Sikkim**; **Yaksham** of **Arunachal Pradesh**

(65) Burrakatha — Instrument Used

Q65. What primary instrument is used in the performance of Burrakatha in Andhra Pradesh?

Answer: Tamboura

→ **Complete Notes**

- ✓ **Burrakatha** — **Andhra Pradesh**
 - ✓ Instrument: **Tamboura** (held in hands by performers)
-

(66) Rauf Dance — Most Notable Feature

Q66. What is the most notable feature of the Rauf dance of Kashmir?

Answer: Intricate footwork

→ Complete Notes

- ✓ **Rauf** — J&K; women perform; Eid/Ramadan/Spring
- ✓ Known for: **Intricate footwork**
- ✓ Tool used: **Wooden sticks** to pound/beat the floor

(67) Shad Sukh Masi — Meghalaya Khasi Thanksgiving

Q67. The dance form Kashd Sukh Mansim is a Thanksgiving dance of which community?

Answer: Khasi tribe (Meghalaya)

→ Complete Meghalaya Folk Dances

Dance	Tribe	Details
Shad Sukh Masi / Kashd Sukh Mansim	Khasi	Thanksgiving dance; also called Joyful Dance
Shad Kyu Lingo	Khasi	—
Nongkrem	Khasi	—
Laho dance	Panar/Jaintia tribe	—
Wangala / Wangala dance	Garo tribe	Festival of 100 Drums
Bahdin Khalam	Jaintia tribe	—

KEY FACTS

Meghalaya Tribes: Garo, Khasi, Jaintia (Panar)

(68) Jhumar — Statements

Q68. Statements about Jhumar:

S1: Harvest dance of Jharkhand performed with Mandar or Nagar drums.

S2: Women alone can perform the Mardani variant wielding swords.

Answer: A — Only Statement 1 is correct

→ Explanation

- ✓ **Statement 1** — Harvest dance; Mandar/Nagar drums exist (Jharkhand)
- ✓ **Statement 2** — **Mardani = for MEN** (Mardani = men's variant); women would NOT wield swords; martial arts generally performed by men

(69) Panthi Dancers — What They Wear

Q69. Panthi dancers wear _____ during the performance.

- ☐ A Kurta
- ☒ B Dhoti
- ☐ C Sari
- ☐ D Lungi

Answer: B — White Dhoti

(70) Paika Dance — Performance Segments Order

Q70. Arrange the performance segments of Paika dance in order: 1) Blowing the war conch 2) Shield and sword sparring drills 3) Acrobatic somersaults 4) Group victory shout of 'Jai Jagannath'

Answer: A — 1, 2, 3, 4

→ Explanation

- ✓ War conch blown **first** (to begin/start any battle/performance)
- ✓ Practice with shield and sword second
- ✓ Acrobatic feats third
- ✓ Victory shout **last** (you shout when you win, at the end)

(71) Lavani — Traditional Percussion Instrument

Q71. What is the traditional percussion instrument used to accompany Lavani?

- A Mridangam
- B Tabla
- C Dholki
- D Nagada

Answer: C — Dholki

(72) Kohli Dance — Which Community

Q72. Kohli dance is traditionally performed by which community?

Answer: Koli (fisherman) community of Maharashtra

→ Complete Notes

- ✓ Kohli = Koli = fisherman community of Maharashtra
- ✓ Also performed in Gujarat (coastal communities)
- ✓ Comment dance / Kohli dance = same tradition

(73) Jhora Dance — Statements

Q73. Statements about Jhora:

S1: Danced in Kumaon by men and women in mixed circles during spring fairs.

S2: Primarily accompanied by the Harka drum.

Answer: C — Both are correct

(74) Tipani/Comment Dance — Statements

Q74. Statements about Comment (Tipani) dance:

S1: Originated in Saurashtra region; women tapping lime floors with wooden sticks.

S2: Male drummers provide Dhol-Nagada accompaniment.

Answer: C — Both are correct

(75) Poikkal Kuthirai Attam — Tamil Nadu Dummy Horse

Q75. Poikkal Kuthirai Attam (Dummy Horse Dance) is performed primarily during religious festivals in which state?

Answer: Tamil Nadu

→ **Complete Notes**

- ✓ **Poikkal Kuthirai Attam** — Tamil Nadu
- ✓ **Feature:** Dummy horse (no legs; person fits inside)

(76) Dollu Kunita — Karnataka Drum Dance

Q76. The folk dance Dollu Kunita, performed with large drums, belongs to which region?

Answer: Karnataka

→ **Complete Notes**

- ✓ **Dollu Kunita** — Karnataka; Kurba community; cylindrical drums
- ✓ **Memory trick:** 'Wherever you see Kunita Karnataka'

(77) Damkach — Folk Song from Jharkhand

Q77. Which folk song from Jharkhand reflects lived experiences, social unity, and often accompanies dance and drama performances?

- ☐ A ~~Lavani (Maharashtra)~~
- ☒ B **Damkach**
- ☐ C ~~Bhavai (Gujarat)~~
- ☐ D ~~Baul (West Bengal)~~

Answer: B — Damkach

(78) Hojagiri Dance — Bru Reang, Tripura

Q78. Hojagiri dance performed by women balancing bottles and lamps is associated with which tribe and state?

Answer: Bru Reang community — Tripura

(79) Kalbelia — Statements (Both Correct)

Q79. Statement about Kalbelia:

Female costumes are black, flowing skirts richly mirror-embroidered. It entered the UNESCO Representative List in 2010.

Answer: Both correct

(80) Match Dance with Social/Religious Context

Q80. Match: Rauf / Karma / Tamasha / Jhumar with their social/religious context.

Answer: RaufEid/Spring | KarmaBhadra Ekadashi | TamashaShimga (Holi) night theatre | JhumarPost-monsoon tea garden

- ✓ RaufEid/Spring season (J&K)
- ✓ KarmaBhadra Ekadashi (Karma festival; CG/Jharkhand/Odisha)
- ✓ TamashaNight-long folk theatre during Shimga season (Maharashtra; Holi time)
- ✓ JhumarPost-monsoon tea garden dance (East India)

(81) Match Dance with Tribe/Community

Q81. Match: Kalbelia / Panthi / Dangi / Paika with their tribe/community.

Answer: KalbeliaSnake tribe RJ | PanthiSatnami CG | DangiDangi/Bhilur Gujarat | PaikaKhandayat Odisha

- ✓ KalbeliaSnake (Sapera) tribe, Rajasthan; UNESCO ICH 2010
 - ✓ PanthiSatnami community, Chhattisgarh, Guru Ghasidas
 - ✓ DangiDangi/Bhilur tribals, Dang district, Gujarat
 - ✓ PaikaKhandayat warrior caste, Odisha
-

(82) Tamasha — Statements (CGL 2025)

Q82. Statements about Tamasha:

S1: It is a Marathi folk theatre genre performed during Shimga (Holi time).

S2: The Kolhati community is traditionally linked with Tamasha troupes.

Answer: C — Both are correct

(83) Pandavani — Chhattisgarh

Q83. In which state is the dance form Pandavani performed?

Answer: Chhattisgarh

KEY FACTS

Famous exponent: Teejan Bai (Padma Shri + Padma Vibhushan 2019)

(84) Karagam — Tamil Nadu

Q84. The folk dance Karagam is primarily performed in which Indian state?

- ☒ A Kerala
- ☒ B Tamil Nadu
- ☐ C Karnataka
- ☐ D Andhra Pradesh

Answer: B — Tamil Nadu

→ Complete Notes

- ✓ Karagam / Karakattam — Tamil Nadu
- ✓ Dedicated to: Goddess Mariamman (Rain Goddess)
- ✓ Performed for: Good rainfall

(85) God Maria Dance — Occasions

Q85. The God Maria dance is performed at various events such as births and marriages.

Answer: True — Bison Horn Maria; Bastar, Chhattisgarh; also associated with Ghotul

(86) Kavadi Attam — Tamil Nadu Devotional Dance for Lord Murugan

Q86. Which is the devotional folk dance of Tamil Nadu performed in praise of Lord Murugan?

- ☒ A ~~Kolattam~~
- ☒ B ~~Kavadi Attam~~
- ☒ C ~~Theyyam (Kerala)~~
- ☒ D ~~Pulikali (Kerala, tiger dance)~~

Answer: B — Kavadi Attam

(87) Launda Naach — Bihar Cross-Dressing Dance

Q87. Which folk dance of Bihar features male performers cross-dressing as women?

Answer: A — Launda Naach

(88) Chholiya Dance — Uttarakhand Sword Dance

Q88. The Chholiya dance is traditionally associated with which Indian state?

Answer: Uttarakhand (Kumaon region)

→ [Complete Notes](#)

✓ *Type: Sword dance / Martial-style dance during weddings*

✓ *Region: Kumaon, Uttarakhand*

(89) Moatsu Festival — Statements

Q89. Statements:

S1: Godmaria dance performed at events like births and marriages (Chhattisgarh).

S2: Moatsu Festival is celebrated after hard work including sowing of seeds; performed by Ao tribe of Nagaland.

Answer: Both Statements 1 and 2 are correct

(90) Pandavani — Which Epic

Q90. Pandavani songs primarily narrate which epic?

Answer: Mahabharata

(91) Salpuri Dance — Odisha

Q91. The folk dance Salpuri is associated with which Indian state?

Answer: Odisha

→ [Complete Notes](#)

✓ *Salpuri — Odisha; very energetic; performed during Nuakhai festival*

- ✓ District: **Sambalpur district** (same district has **Hirakud Dam** — India's longest dam)
 - ✓ Dancer wears **anklets on feet**
-

(92) Dalkhai — Odisha

Q92. *Dalkhai is a folk dance in which Indian state?*

Answer: Odisha (Western Odisha)

→ **Complete Notes**

- ✓ **Dalkhai** — Western Odisha
 - ✓ Theme: **Radha and Krishna's love stories**
 - ✓ Performed by: Women
-

(93) Natyanjali Festival — Dedicated to Which Deity

Q93. *The Natyanjali Dance Festival in Chidambaram, Tamil Nadu is dedicated to which deity?*

Answer: Lord Nataraja (cosmic dancer form of Lord Shiva)

→ **Complete Notes**

- ✓ Occasion: **Mahashivratri**
 - ✓ Location: **Chidambaram temple + all Shiva temples**
 - ✓ Natya = Dance; Anjali = Offering
 - ✓ Both a dance and a festival (like Bihu, Lai Haraoba)
-

(94) Tera Tali — Which State

Q94. In which state is Tera Tali performed?

Answer: Rajasthan (Kamada tribe, Marwar region, Baba Ramdev)

EXAM TRAP

If Rajasthan NOT in options then **MP** (Kamar tribe, Taratali) — similar 13-clap concept, different state

(95) Bugurumba — Current Affairs 2026

Q95. Bugurumba repeated — from which state?

Answer: Assam — Bodo tribe — Butterfly Dance

EXAM TIP

Current Affairs 2026:

- Modi visited Assam **10,000+** performers performed Bugurumba
- Venue: **Arjun Bhogeshwar Barua Stadium (formerly Sarusajai Stadium), Guwahati**
- Created: **Guinness World Record**
- Called: **Bugurumba Dhau**

(96) Folk Dance Forms — Why Deeply Rooted

Q96. Folk dance forms are deeply rooted in specific social contexts because they represent which aspects of community?

- ☐ A ~~Economic practices~~
- ☐ B ~~Political structures~~
- ☐ C ~~Religious texts and philosophies~~
- ☒ D **Beliefs, rituals, customs, and symbolism**

Answer: D — Beliefs, Rituals, Customs, and Symbolism

→ **Explanation**

- ✓ Performed at marriages, childbirth, festivals, sowing, harvesting all are **customs and beliefs**
- ✓ Folk dances = lived community traditions (not formal economic or political structures)

(97) Phagg Dance — When Performed

Q?? Phagg dance from Haryana is performed when?

Answer: During Holi (spring season, month of Chaitra)

(98) Which is NOT a Folk Dance of Gujarat

Q?8 Which of the following is NOT a folk dance of Gujarat?

- ☐ A Dandiya-Raas
- ☐ B Garba
- ☐ C Tipani/Comment
- ☒ D Gidda

Answer: D — Gidda (from Punjab)

→ [Complete Notes](#)

- ✓ **Gidda**: Punjab (women-only dance; Teej & Lohri)
- ✓ Dandiya, Garba, Tipani are all genuine Gujarat folk dances

(99) Mayurbhanj Chhau — Odisha

Q?? Mayurbhanj Chhau is a classical martial folk dance from which state?

Answer: Odisha

(100) Yakshagana — Karnataka

Q100. Which folk dance of Karnataka combines dance, music, dialogue, costume, and stage techniques with a unique style?

Answer: Yakshagana — Karnataka

(101) Gidda — Who Performs It

Q101. Gidda is a traditional folk dance of India. Who performs it?

Answer: Women of Punjab

→ **Complete Notes**

- ✓ **Gidda:** Punjab; performed by **women only**
- ✓ **Occasions:** Teej and Lohri; songs = **Boliyan**
- ✓ **Formation:** circle or holding hands; clapping style

(102) Dhol — Essential Instrument in Which Folk Dance

Q102. The dhol is an essential instrument in which Indian folk music/dance?

- A** Ghoomar
- B** Garba
- C** Rauf
- D** Bhangra

Answer: D — Bhangra (Punjab)

→ **Complete Notes**

- ✓ **Bhangra:** Punjab; most famous folk dance; instrument = **Dhol**
- ✓ **Region:** Sandalbar

✓ Other Punjab: Gidda (women), Jago (weddings), Luddi (Sandalbar)

Topper Tips — Exam Ke Liye Yaad Rakho!

EXAM TIP

1. **Ghoomar** = Rajasthan | **Garba** = Gujarat | **Bihu** = Assam — never mix these 3!
2. **Chhau** = 3 states | Only **Mayurbhanj (Odisha)** has NO mask
3. **Chhau + Kalbelia** = BOTH UNESCO 2010 | **Garba** = 2023 (newest)
4. **Nati** of HP = Guinness World Record for LARGEST folk dance!

EXAM TIP

5. **Cheraw** = Mizoram (bamboo poles) — NOT Manipur!
6. **Bihu** 3 types: **Bohag** (April, joyous) **Kongali** (Oct, sombre) **Bhogali** (Jan, feast)
7. **Bhangra** = Men | **Giddha** = Women — both Punjab, both Baisakhi
8. **Tribe = Dance**: **Reang**=Hojagiri | **Khasi**=Nongkrem | **Satnami**=Panthi

EXAM TRAP

Memory trick: "**Kunita**" Karnataka | "**Chhau**" East India (WB/JH/OD) | "**Bihu**" Assam | "**Pung**" Manipur
UNESCO list: Kalbelia (2010) | Chhau (2010) | Garba (2023) | **Ghoomar NEVER listed**

END OF FOLK DANCES OF INDIA — 102 QUESTIONS COVERED

All States Covered | Padho, Yaad karo, Top karo!

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